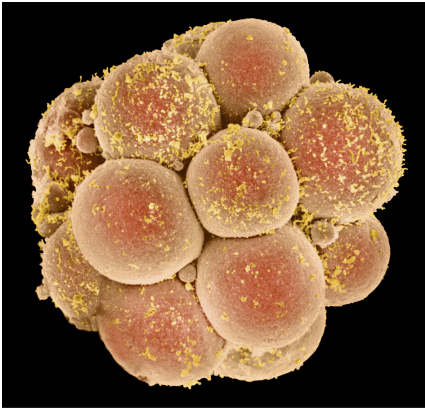




YOU ARE **2 WEEKS AND 4 DAYS**

262 days to go

WHAT'S HAPPENING INSIDE

This is an embryo at the 16-cell stage, when it has changed from a zygote into a morula. It is in the process of dividing into a hollow ball of cells, the blastocyst, which will eventually implant in the lining of the uterus.

“Significant changes are taking place daily within your uterus and within just 72 hours from now, the fertilized egg will implant.”

Around four days following fertilization, fluid begins to collect within the [morula](#). This creates a separate outer cell layer, one cell thick that encapsulates an inner mass of cells. The inner layer will become the embryo, and the outer layer the [placenta](#). The whole structure now consists of approximately 58 cells and is termed the “blastocyst.”

The blastocyst spends several days within the cavity of the uterus before implanting. The morula had an impenetrable outer surface as it traveled, but this disappears as the blastocyst prepares for implantation in the lining of the uterus.

ASK A MOM

How can I stop people asking me whether or not I've conceived? I certainly found that once I'd told people I was trying to have a baby, they were inordinately interested in the process. It was difficult, especially in the week when I was waiting to find out if I'd conceived. The best way to deal with it is to respond by saying that you'll let people know if there's news. If you're struggling to conceive, telling people you're having difficulties should help stop them from asking.

THE ALTERNATIVE APPROACH TO FERTILITY

If you're having difficulty conceiving, or just want to improve your chances, consider using a complementary therapy. Always inform the practitioner that you might be pregnant.

- **Reflexology** works by manipulating pressure points in the feet to improve energy flow to specific parts of the body. While there is plenty of anecdotal evidence that reflexology helps conception, this isn't currently backed up by scientific research. However, it may help relieve stress, which can be a factor in couples who have problems conceiving.
- **Acupuncture** (see [image](#)) works on the principle that problems such as infertility are caused by blockages in the body's energy flow or “qi.” By inserting tiny needles into energy points that are linked to the reproductive organs, the flow is restored. The recent scientific evidence is debatable—some studies suggest a beneficial effect while others do not. However, if it